04-08 第一篇

The Power of Animal-Assisted Therapy

When you feel stressed or lonely, have you ever noticed how spending time with a pet can make you feel better? This is not just a pleasant feeling—it is a real effect that scientists and therapists have been studying for decades. [1] Dogs, cats, rabbits, and even horses are now used in hospitals, schools, and nursing homes to help people recover faster and feel more at ease. This practice is called animal-assisted therapy (AAT), and it is becoming more popular around the world.

How does it work? Research shows that being around friendly animals can lower blood pressure and reduce the level of cortisol, a stress hormone in our bodies. [2] Simply petting a dog or watching fish swim in a tank can slow down your heartbeat and help you relax. For people who are sick or recovering from surgery, this calm state can support healing. Some studies have even found that patients who spend time with therapy animals need less pain medication than those who do not.

Children benefit in special ways too. [3] Kids who have trouble reading aloud often feel less nervous when they read to a dog instead of a person. The dog does not judge or correct them, so they gain confidence and practice more often. Schools in many countries now bring in therapy dogs to help students who struggle with anxiety or find it hard to focus in class. The presence of a calm animal seems to create a safe and supportive environment.

AAT is also used to help people with mental health challenges. [4] Veterans who have experienced war, for example, may find it easier to talk about their feelings when a dog is by their side. People with depression or autism sometimes form strong bonds with animals when connecting with humans feels difficult. Therapists say that animals offer unconditional love and acceptance, which can be a powerful first step toward healing.

[5] Whether it is a dog visiting a hospital, a cat comforting someone at home, or a horse helping a child with special needs, animals have a unique ability to support human well-being. As we learn more about this connection, the role of animals in healthcare and education is likely to grow even further.

选项

A. In fact, even simple interactions with animals can have a calming effect. B. Today, many different kinds of animals are trained to work as therapy helpers. C. Animals may also help with physical exercise and outdoor activities. D. For instance, some programs use animals to improve reading skills and reduce anxiety in young learners. E. In these

cases, animals often serve as a bridge to help people open up and feel safer. F. All in all, the bond between humans and animals can be a valuable tool for healing and growth.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] B [2] A [3] D [4] E [5] F

深度解析

- **[1] B**：
  - **线索**：引入展开与例证衔接。空前总述"AAT is becoming more popular around the world"，空后列举"Dogs, cats, rabbits, and even horses are now used in hospitals, schools, and nursing homes"。B选项"Today, many different kinds of animals are trained to work as therapy helpers"（如今，多种动物被训练为治疗助手）中"many different kinds of animals"自然引出空后对狗、猫、兔子、马等的具体列举，"therapy helpers"与"animal-assisted therapy"主题呼应，逻辑顺畅。
- **[2] A**：
  - **线索**：研究结论与具体展开。空前提出"being around friendly animals can lower blood pressure and reduce cortisol"，空后"Simply petting a dog or watching fish swim in a tank can slow down your heartbeat and help you relax"。A选项"In fact, even simple interactions with animals can have a calming effect"（事实上，即使与动物的简单互动也能产生 calming 效果）中"simple interactions"与空后"petting a dog or watching fish"对应，"calming effect"与"slow down your heartbeat...relax"以及前文"lower blood pressure"形成递进，衔接紧密。
- **[3] D**：
  - **线索**：儿童受益与例证引入。空前指出"Children benefit in special ways too"，空后具体描述"Kids who have trouble reading aloud often feel less nervous when they read to a dog"。D选项"For instance, some programs use animals to improve reading skills and reduce anxiety in young learners"（例如，一些项目利用动物提高青少年的阅读能力并减轻焦虑）中"For instance"引出例证，"improve reading skills"与"read to a dog...gain confidence and practice"对应，"reduce anxiety"与"feel less nervous"呼应，完美衔接。
- **[4] E**：
  - **线索**：心理健康应用与机制说明。空前指出"AAT is also used to help people with mental health challenges"，空后举例"Veterans...may find it easier to talk about their feelings when a dog is by their side...People with depression or autism...form strong bonds with animals when connecting with humans feels

difficult"。E选项"In these cases, animals often serve as a bridge to help people open up and feel safer"（在这些情况下，动物常常充当桥梁，帮助人们敞开心扉、感到更安全）中"In these cases"指代心理健康情境，"bridge"与"easier to talk...form strong bonds when connecting with humans feels difficult"高度契合，逻辑顺畅。

- [5] F：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"dog visiting a hospital, cat comforting someone at home, horse helping a child with special needs"并总结"animals have a unique ability to support human well-being"。F选项"All in all, the bond between humans and animals can be a valuable tool for healing and growth"（总之，人与动物之间的纽带可以成为疗愈与成长的宝贵工具）用"All in all"总结全文，"healing and growth"呼应前文医疗、教育、心理健康各层面，"valuable tool"与空后"unique ability"形成升华，收束得当。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **C. Animals may also help with physical exercise and outdoor activities.**：提及动物对身体锻炼和户外活动的帮助，与AAT主题相关，看似可填[2]或[3]。但空[2]前后文聚焦"lower blood pressure...cortisol...petting a dog...relax"，强调的是放松与减压，C的"physical exercise and outdoor activities"与前文"calm state...relax"逻辑不符；空[3]前后文讲阅读与焦虑，C与"reading to a dog...anxiety"无直接关联。属"主题相关但功能错位"型干扰。